

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12407734
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Israel; Erez et al.

Autonomous network policy generator

Abstract

A device, system, and method are provided for generating a network security policy automatically based on network traffic. The network security policy is generated by building a directional graph from the network traffic, with the nodes of the graph representing network end points, and the edges representing communication between two nodes on a communication channel. A feature vector is generated for each of the nodes and a graph neural network is applied to the feature vectors to generate output vectors. The output vectors are clustered using a cost function based on a weighted combination of a distance-based cost function and a network functionality cost function. The clusters generated from the output vectors are used to assign network security rules to each of the clusters.

Inventors: Israel; Erez (Tel Aviv, IL), Goldman; Lior (Raanana, IL), Katz; Natan (Tel Aviv, IL)

Applicant: CHECK POINT SOFTWARE TECHNOLOGIES LTD. (Tel Aviv, IL)

Family ID: 96173731

Assignee: CHECK POINT SOFTWARE TECHNOLOGIES LTD. (Tel Aviv, IL)

Appl. No.: 18/401547

Filed: December 31, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20250220049 A1	Jul. 03, 2025

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: G06F21/57 (20130101); H04L9/40 (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H04L63/20** (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

USPC: None

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
2022/0053015	12/2021	Jones	N/A	G06F 21/577
2023/0090205	12/2022	Yehezkel	726/23	H04L 63/1425
2023/0239204	12/2022	Hayrapetyan	709/221	H04L 41/0893

Primary Examiner: Traore; Fatoumata

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Renner, Otto, Boisselle & Sklar, LLP

Background/Summary

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates generally to computer security and more particularly to generating a network policy.

BACKGROUND

(2) The configuration and maintenance of security policies (e.g., firewall policies) plays an important role in safeguarding the digital assets of companies and organizations. These policies are used to segment and direct network traffic to prevent unauthorized access through the network.

(3) With the advent of cloud computing, mobile computing, and the Internet of Things (IoT), traffic within networks has become more complex. This complexity makes it challenging to develop security policies that are both comprehensive and adaptable. Traditional approaches often result in policies that are either overly restrictive (i.e., impeding legitimate network traffic) or too lenient (i.e., leaving vulnerabilities unaddressed).

(4) The manual configuration of these policies is not only time-consuming but also prone to human error. Network administrators must meticulously specify which traffic is allowed or blocked based on numerous parameters such as IP addresses, URLs, port numbers, and protocols. Any misconfiguration can lead to security breaches or network disruptions. Furthermore, as the organization grows and its network evolves, maintaining and updating these policies becomes increasingly burdensome.

SUMMARY

(5) The present disclosure provides a method, computer device, and system for generating a network security policy by clustering network end points using an embedding of a directional graph of network communications between the network end points.

(6) While a number of features are described herein with respect to embodiments of the invention; features described with respect to a given embodiment also may be employed in connection with other embodiments. The following description and the annexed drawings set forth certain

illustrative embodiments of the invention. These embodiments are indicative, however, of but a few of the many ways in which the principles of the invention may be employed. Other objects, advantages, and novel features according to aspects of the invention will become apparent from the following detailed description when considered in conjunction with the drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The annexed drawings, which are not necessarily to scale, show various aspects of the invention in which similar reference numerals are used to indicate the same or similar parts in the various views.

(2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram of an embodiment of a system for automatically generating and applying a network security policy based on network traffic.

(3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a portion of a graph showing server and client nodes.

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a graph showing nodes and edges representing network traffic.

(5) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram of an embodiment of a method for generating a network security policy automatically using processor circuitry based on network traffic.

(6) The present invention is described below in detail with reference to the drawings. In the drawings, each element with a reference number is similar to other elements with the same reference number independent of any letter designation following the reference number. In the text, a reference number with a specific letter designation following the reference number refers to the specific element with the number and letter designation and a reference number without a specific letter designation refers to all elements with the same reference number independent of any letter designation following the reference number in the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(7) The present disclosure provides a device, system and method for generating a network security policy automatically based on network traffic. The network security policy is generated by building a directional multigraph from the network traffic, with the nodes of the graph representing network end points, and the edges representing communication between two nodes on a communication channel. A feature vector is generated for each of the nodes and a graph neural network is applied to the feature vectors to generate output vectors. The output vectors are clustered using a cost function based on a weighted combination of a distance-based cost function and a network functionality cost function. The weights of the cost functions are altered using a weight setting function. The clusters generated from the output vectors are used to assign network security rules to each of the clusters such that the nodes included in each of the clusters are permitted to perform the network communications included in the network data for the nodes included in the cluster.

(8) According to a general embodiment shown in FIG. 1, a system **10** is provided for automatically generating and applying a network security policy **11** based on network traffic. The system **10** includes a computer device **12** and networking hardware **14**. Generally, the computer device **12** analyzes the network traffic to generate the network security policy **11** and sends the network security policy **11** to the networking hardware **14**. The networking hardware **14** routes the network traffic and implements the network security policy **11**.

(9) The computer device **12** includes processor circuitry **16** for receiving network connection data **18** for network connections **20** in the network traffic. Each network connection **20** is on a communication channel **22** between two end points **24**. For example, each communication channel may represent one or more of a port, application type (e.g., Skype, Teams, etc.), URL or part of a URL (e.g. scheme://hostname scheme://hostname/path), etc. The network connection data **18** may be received from any suitable source or sources. For example, the network connection data **18** (or a part of the network connection data **18**) may be received from the networking hardware **14**.

(10) With exemplary reference to FIGS. 2 and 3, the processor circuitry **16** generates a graph **30** based on the received network connection data **18**. That is, the generated graph **30** represents communications between the different network end points. To generate the graph **30**, the processor circuitry **16** identifies nodes **32** in the graph **30**. Each node **32** represents an end point **24** of a network connection **20** in the network connection data **18**. For example, each node **32** in the graph **30** may represent at least one of an internet protocol (IP) address, a user identifier, or an application identifier.

(11) The processor circuitry **16** also generates edges **34** between the identified nodes **32**. As shown in FIG. 2, each edge **34** is directional and connects a client node **32a** and a server node **32b**. That is, each edge **34** represents communication on a communication channel **22** from the client node **32a** to the server node **32b**. The processor circuitry **16** may also apply weights **36** to the edges **34**. The weight **36** of each of the edges may be based on a number of network connections **20** from the client node **32a** to the server node **32b** on the communication channel **22** represented by the edge **34**. The weight **36** may additionally or alternatively be modified by applying different weights to internal connections, to predetermined machines, etc.

(12) Because each edge represents directional communication between a client node **32a** and a server node **32b** on a communication channel **22**, there may be multiple edges connecting two nodes. For example, in FIG. 2, the client node **32a** has two edges **34a**, **34b** (representing communication on two different communication channels) with left server node **32b**. Similarly, the client node **32a** also has two edges **34c**, **34d** (representing communication on two different communication channels) with the right server node **32b**. FIG. 3 represents network communication between a greater number of network end points (i.e., nodes **32**), with the nodes **32** having multiple edges **34** connecting between the nodes.

(13) After generating the graph **30**, the processor circuitry **16** generates a feature vector **40** for each of the nodes **32** in the graph **30**. The feature vector **40** may include any suitable information for representing network communication for the node represented by the feature vector **40**. For example, each feature vector **40** may include a representation of an internet protocol (IP) address of the node **32**, a representation of network connections with the node on multiple predetermined communication channels, and a collective representation of network connections with the node on other communication channels (e.g., communication channels other than the multiple predetermined communication channels).

(14) The multiple predetermined communication channels may comprise a list of the most commonly used communication channels. For example, the multiple predetermined communication channels may comprise a list of at least 3,000 of the most popularly used ports, such as TCP/22 (SSH), TCP/53 and UDP/53 (DNS), TCP/80 (HTTP), TCP/443 (HTTPS). The multiple predetermined communication channels may be chosen based on an analysis of the network connection data or in any suitable manner.

(15) For each communication channel **22** of the multiple predetermined communication channels, a representation of the communication channel is included in the feature vector **40** based on the edges extending towards the node on the communication channel **22** and the edges extending from the node on the communication channel **22**. For example, for each edge **34** extending from the node as the client node **32a**, the feature vector **40** may include a representation of (1) the weight **36** of the edge **34** and (2) the server node **32b** of the edge **34**. Similarly, for each edge **34** extending to the node **32** as the server node **32b**, the feature vector **40** may include a representation of (1) the weight **36** of the edge **34** and (2) the client node **32a** of the edge **34**.

(16) Regarding the other communication channels not included in the predetermined communication channels, the feature vector **40** may include a representation of the other communication channels based on the weight **36** of the edges **34** extending from the node **32** as the communication channel on any of the other communication channels. That is, instead of including a representation of every communication channel **22** individually, the feature vector **40** may group

together network connections to communication channels not included in the predetermined communication channels. For example, these other communication channels may be considered less important in determining the network security policy **11** than the predetermined communication channels. For this reason, these other communication channels may be consolidated together in the feature vector **40**. For example, the representation of the other communication channels in the feature vector **40** may be determined based on a summation of the weights **36** of edges **34** for the other communication channels.

(17) As described above, the feature vector **40** may include any additional information for categorizing network connections. For example, the feature vector **40** may include Boolean values identifying client nodes **32a** and server nodes **32b** as internal or external IP addresses. The feature vector **40** may also include information identifying a type of machine represented by a node **32**. For example, the feature vector **40** may identify a node as a Kubernetes container, a server, a personal computer, a mobile device, etc.

(18) After generating the graph **30**, the processor circuitry **16** may generate a node embedding comprising an output vector **50** for each of the nodes **32** of the graph **30** by applying a graph neural network **52** to the feature vectors **40**. The graph neural network **52** may be any suitable graph neural network, such as a graph attention network. The computer device **12** may include memory **53** (e.g., a non-transitory computer readable medium) for storing the graph neural network **52**.

(19) The graph neural network **52** has been trained to generate the node embedding using a cost function **54** modified by a weight setting function **56**. The cost function **54** includes a distance-based cost function **58** and a network functionality cost function **60**. The weight setting function **56** modifies a weight **62** applied to the distance-based cost function **58** and a weight **64** applied to the network functionality cost function **60**. For example, the cost function **54** may be a summation of the distance-based cost function **58** multiplied by the weight **62** and the network functionality cost function **60** multiplied by the weight **64**.

(20) The distance-based cost function **58** is configured to group together in space (e.g., Euclidian space) the output vectors **50** for nodes **32** that are connected by an edge **34**. The distance-based cost function **58** similarly pushes apart in space the output vectors **50** for nodes **32** that are not connected by an edge **34**.

(21) The network functionality cost function **60** groups together in space the output vectors **50** for nodes **32** based on a number of similar edges. A similar edge is an edge **34** having a same communication channel but may connect different nodes. That is, the network functionality cost function **60** pulls together in space output vectors **50** having more similar edges while pushing apart in space the output vectors **50** having fewer similar edges.

(22) The weight setting function **56** first sets the weight **62** applied to the distance-based cost function **58** to a higher weight than the weight **64** of the network functionality cost function **60**. The weight setting function **56** later sets the weight **62** applied to the distance-based cost function **58** to a lower weight than the weight **64** of the network functionality cost function **60**. For example, training of the graph neural network **52** may initially be controlled primarily by the distance-based cost function **58** by setting the weight **62** of the distance-based cost function **58** higher than the weight **64** of the network functionality cost function **60**. The weights **62**, **64** may then be adjusted by the cost function **54**, such that later training of the graph neural network **52** is primarily controlled by the network functionality cost function **60**.

(23) The weight setting function **56** may modify the weights **62**, **64** in any suitable manner. For example, the weight setting function **56** may non-linearly vary the weight **62** applied to the distance-based cost function **58** and the weight **64** applied to the network functionality cost function **60** based on a distance between the output vectors in space.

(24) As an example, at a beginning of training for a pair of points, a weight of one may be applied to the distance-based cost function **58** and a weight of zero may be applied to the network functionality cost function **60**. That is, the cost function **54** may only take into account the

distance-based cost function at first. At a later time (e.g., once a distance between the output vectors **50** has been decreased below a threshold), a weight of zero may be applied to the distance-based cost function **58** and a weight of one may be applied to the network functionality cost function **60**. That is, the cost function **54** may only take into account the network functionality cost function **60**.

(25) After generating the node embedding, the processor circuitry **16** generates the network security policy **11** from the generated output vectors **50**. In particular, the processor circuitry **16** generates the network security policy **11** by identifying clusters in the output vectors **50**. The processor circuitry **16** then generates network security rules **74** for each of the identified clusters. The security rules **74** are generated so that the network connections **20** included in the network connection data **18** involving the nodes **32** included in the cluster are permitted by the network security rules **74** for the nodes **32** included in the cluster. That is, the network security rules **74** allow the nodes **32** in the cluster to perform the network connections **20** included in the network connection data **18** for the nodes **32** in the cluster. As an example, if one of the nodes **32** in a cluster included a network connection **20** with an IP address for a DNS server on port **53**, then the network security rules **74** would permit all of the nodes **32** in the cluster to communicate over port **53** with the DNS server at the IP address. Similarly, if one of the nodes **32** in a cluster included a network connection **20** with a URL for a server, then the network security rules may permit all of the nodes **32** in the cluster to communicate with the URL.

(26) The processor circuitry **16** may also generate the network security policy **11** such that, for each cluster, any network connections **20** not included in the network connection data **18** involving the nodes included in the cluster are blocked by the network security rules for the nodes included in the cluster. For example, if no nodes in a cluster connected on port **8080** to a particular server in the network connection data **18**, then the network security rules for the cluster may block connections to the particular server on port **8080**.

(27) When generating the network security rules **74**, the processor circuitry **16** may analyze inbound traffic and outbound traffic to each node. For each cluster, the processor circuitry **16** may aggregate the inbound traffic for nodes **32** in the cluster based on communication channel and source. For example, the processor circuitry **16** may aggregate traffic for a cluster by defining a range of IP addresses for a communication channel for incoming connections in a network security rule **74**. Similarly, for each cluster, the processor circuitry **16** may similarly aggregate outbound traffic for each node in the cluster based on communication channel and destination. Continuing the above example, the processor circuitry **16** may aggregate traffic for a cluster by defining a range of IP addresses and range of ports for outgoing connections in a network security rule **74**. Similarly, the processor circuitry **16** may aggregate traffic for a cluster by defining a range of IP addresses and range of ports for incoming connections in a network security rule **74**.

(28) The processor circuitry **16** combines the network security rules **74** to form the network security policy **11** and outputs the generated network security policy **11**. For example, the processor circuitry **16** may transmit the network security policy **11** to the networking hardware **14**. The network security policy **11** may be applied in a public cloud environment (e.g. Amazon Web Services, Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform). For example, the network security policy **11** could be used to configure the public cloud native security controls of such cloud provides such as network ACLs, security groups and or WAF (Web Application Firewall).

(29) The networking hardware **14** may implement the network security policy **11** generated by the computer device **12**. That is, the networking hardware **14** applies the received network security policy **11** to the network connections **20**. The networking hardware **14** includes computer circuitry **80** for routing network connections **20** between network end points. For example, the networking hardware **14** may be a firewall, network switch, network router, or other similar hardware for implementing the network security policy and for routing network traffic. The computer circuitry **80** may log the network traffic as network connection data **18** and send the logged network

connection data **18** to the computer device **12**.

(30) As described above, the network connection data **18** may be received from one or more sources. For example, the network connection data **18** may be determined by receiving network traffic logs from various sources and by deduplicating network connections containing in the network traffic logs (e.g., if the same network traffic is recorded in different logs, the network traffic may be deduplicated and correlated to ensure the same network traffic is not included multiple times in the network connection data **18**). As an example, the network traffic logs could be generated by intermediate networking devices and/or the network endpoints. When generated by the network endpoints, the network connection data could be generated by agents running on the endpoint by the application generating the network traffic, such as a web client or server or a browser extension.

(31) The processor circuitry **16** and computer circuitry **80** may have various implementations. For example, the processor circuitry **16** and computer circuitry **80** may include any suitable device, such as a processor (e.g., CPU), programmable circuit, integrated circuit, memory and I/O circuits, an application specific integrated circuit, microcontroller, complex programmable logic device, other programmable circuits, or the like. The processor circuitry **16** and computer circuitry **80** may be located on one or more discrete and separate pieces of hardware. The processor circuitry **16** and computer circuitry **80** may also include a non-transitory computer readable medium, such as random-access memory (RAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM or Flash memory), or any other suitable medium. Instructions for performing the method described below may be stored in the non-transitory computer readable medium and executed by the processor circuitry **16** and computer circuitry **80**. The processor circuitry **16** and computer circuitry **80** may be communicatively coupled to the computer readable medium and communication interface through a system bus, mother board, or using any other suitable structure known in the art.

(32) The memory **53** may be any suitable computer readable medium, such as one or more of a buffer, a flash memory, a hard drive, a removable media, a volatile memory, a non-volatile memory, a random-access memory (RAM), or other suitable device. In a typical arrangement, the memory **53** may include a non-volatile memory for long term data storage and a volatile memory that functions as system memory for the processor **16**. The memory may exchange data with the processor circuitry **16** over a data bus. Accompanying control lines and an address bus between the memory **53** and the processor circuitry **16**, **80** also may be present. The memory **53** is considered a non-transitory computer readable medium.

(33) In the embodiment depicted in FIG. **4**, a method **100** implemented by the processor circuitry **16** is shown for generating a network security policy automatically using processor circuitry based on network traffic. In step **102**, the processor circuitry receives network connection data for network connections in the network traffic. In step **104**, the processor circuitry generates a graph based on the received network connection data. As described above, generating the graph includes identifying nodes in the graph; generating edges between the identified nodes; and, for each of the nodes in the graph, generating a feature vector.

(34) In step **106**, the processor circuitry generates a node embedding comprising an output vector for each of the nodes of the graph by applying a graph neural network to the feature vectors of the nodes in the graph. In step **108**, the processor circuitry generates the network security policy. As described above, generating the network security policy includes identifying clusters in the output vectors of the generated node embedding; generating network security rules for each of the identified clusters; and combining the network security rules to form the network security policy. In step **110**, the processor circuitry outputs the generated network security policy.

(35) Implementation of the method and/or system of embodiments of the invention can involve performing or completing selected tasks manually, automatically, or a combination thereof. Moreover, according to actual instrumentation and equipment of embodiments of the method

and/or system of the invention, several selected tasks could be implemented by hardware, by software or by firmware or by a combination thereof using an operating system.

(36) For example, hardware for performing selected tasks according to embodiments of the invention could be implemented as a chip or a circuit. As software, selected tasks according to embodiments of the invention could be implemented as a plurality of software instructions being executed by a computer using any suitable operating system. In an exemplary embodiment of the invention, one or more tasks according to exemplary embodiments of method and/or system as described herein are performed by a data processor, such as a computing platform for executing a plurality of instructions. Optionally, the data processor includes a volatile memory for storing instructions and/or data and/or a non-volatile storage, for example, non-transitory storage media such as a magnetic hard-disk and/or removable media, for storing instructions and/or data. Optionally, a network connection is provided as well. A display and/or a user input device such as a keyboard or mouse are optionally provided as well.

(37) The flowchart and block diagrams in the Figures illustrate the architecture, functionality, and operation of possible implementations of systems, methods, and computer program products according to various embodiments of the present invention. In this regard, each block in the flowchart or block diagrams may represent a module, segment, or portion of code, which comprises one or more executable instructions for implementing the specified logical function(s). It should also be noted that, in some alternative implementations, the functions noted in the block may occur out of the order noted in the figures. For example, two blocks shown in succession may, in fact, be executed substantially concurrently, or the blocks may sometimes be executed in the reverse order, depending upon the functionality involved. It will also be noted that each block of the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, and combinations of blocks in the block diagrams and/or flowchart illustration, can be implemented by special purpose hardware-based systems that perform the specified functions or acts, or combinations of special purpose hardware and computer instructions.

(38) The above-described processes including portions thereof can be performed by software, hardware, and combinations thereof. These processes and portions thereof can be performed by computers, computer-type devices, workstations, processors, micro-processors, other electronic searching tools and memory and other non-transitory storage-type devices associated therewith. The processes and portions thereof can also be embodied in programmable non-transitory storage media, for example, compact discs (CDs) or other discs including magnetic, optical, etc., readable by a machine or the like, or other computer usable storage media, including magnetic, optical, or semiconductor storage, or other source of electronic signals.

(39) All ranges and ratio limits disclosed in the specification and claims may be combined in any manner. Unless specifically stated otherwise, references to “a,” “an,” and/or “the” may include one or more than one, and that reference to an item in the singular may also include the item in the plural.

(40) Although the invention has been shown and described with respect to a certain embodiment or embodiments, equivalent alterations and modifications will occur to others skilled in the art upon the reading and understanding of this specification and the annexed drawings. In particular regard to the various functions performed by the above described elements (components, assemblies, devices, compositions, etc.), the terms (including a reference to a “means”) used to describe such elements are intended to correspond, unless otherwise indicated, to any element which performs the specified function of the described element (i.e., that is functionally equivalent), even though not structurally equivalent to the disclosed structure which performs the function in the herein illustrated exemplary embodiment or embodiments of the invention. In addition, while a particular feature of the invention may have been described above with respect to only one or more of several illustrated embodiments, such feature may be combined with one or more other features of the other embodiments, as may be desired and advantageous for any given or particular application.

Claims

1. A computer device for generating a network security policy automatically based on network traffic comprising: processor circuitry configured to: receive network connection data for network connections in the network traffic, wherein each network connection is on a communication channel between two end points; generate a graph based on the received network connection data comprising: identifying nodes in the graph, wherein each node in the graph comprises an end point of a network connection in the network connection data; generating edges between the identified nodes, wherein each edge of the generated edges: is directional and connects a client node and a server node; and represents communication on a communication channel from the client node to the server node; for each of the nodes in the graph, generating a feature vector including: an identifier of the node; and for each communication channel of multiple predetermined communication channels, a representation of the communication channel based on: the server node of each of the edges extending from the node as the client node on the communication channel; the client node of each of the edges extending to the node as the server node on the communication channel; and a collective representation of other communication channels not included in the predetermined communication channels; generating a node embedding comprising an output vector for each of the nodes of the graph by applying a graph neural network to the feature vectors of the nodes in the graph, wherein: the graph neural network is trained using a cost function modified by a weight setting function; the cost function includes a distance-based cost function and a network functionality cost function; the weight setting function is configured to modify a weight applied to the distance-based cost function and a weight applied to the network functionality cost function, such that: a higher weight is first applied to the distance-based cost function than the network functionality cost function; and a higher weight is later applied to the network functionality cost function than the distance-based cost function; the distance-based cost function is configured to: group together in space the output vectors for nodes that are connected by an edge; and push apart in space the output vectors for nodes not connected by an edge; and the network functionality cost function is configured to group together in space the output vectors for nodes based on a number of similar edges, such that: the output vectors for nodes having more similar edges are pulled together in space while the output vectors for nodes having fewer similar edges are pushed apart in space, wherein a similar edge is an edge having a same server node or a same client node; generating the network security policy comprising: identifying clusters in the output vectors of the generated node embedding; generating network security rules for each of the identified clusters, such that the network connections included in the network connection data involving the nodes included in the cluster are permitted by the network security rules for the nodes included in the cluster; and combining the network security rules to form the network security policy; and outputting the generated network security policy.
2. The computer device of claim 1, wherein each node in the graph represents at least one of an internet protocol (IP) address, a user identifier, or an application identifier.
3. The computer device of claim 1, wherein the communication channel for each network connection represents one or more of a port, application type, URL, or part of a URL.
4. The computer device of claim 1, wherein: the generating of the graph based on the received network connection data further comprises: applying weights to the generated edges, such that each of the generated edges has a weight based on a number of network connections in the network connection data from the client node to the server node on the communication channel represented by the edge; the representation of the communication channel is also based on: the weight of each of the edges extending from the node as the client node on the communication channel; and the weight of each of the edges extending to the node as the server node on the communication channel; and the collective representation of other communication channels not included in the

predetermined communication channels is based on the weight of the edges extending from the node as the communication channel on any of the other communication channels.

5. The computer device of claim 1, wherein the graph neural network is a graph attention network.

6. The computer device of claim 1, wherein the weight setting function is configured to non-linearly vary the weight applied to the distance-based cost function and the weight applied to the network functionality cost function based on a distance between the output vectors.

7. The computer device of claim 1, wherein: the weight first applied to the distance-based cost function is one and the weight first applied to the network functionality cost function is zero; and the weight later applied to the distance-based cost function is zero and the weight later applied to the network functionality cost function is one.

8. The computer device of claim 1, wherein the network security policy for each of the identified clusters is generated, such that any network connections not included in the network connection data involving the nodes included in the cluster are blocked by the network security rules for the nodes included in the cluster.

9. A system for automatically generating and applying a network security policy based on network traffic comprising: a computer device including processor circuitry configured to: receive network connection data for network connections in the network traffic, wherein each network connection is on a communication channel between two end points; generate a graph based on the received network connection data comprising: identifying nodes in the graph, wherein each node in the graph comprises an end point of a network connection in the network connection data; generating edges between the identified nodes, wherein each edge of the generated edges: is directional and connects a client node and a server node; and represents communication on a communication channel from the client node to the server node; for each of the nodes in the graph, generating a feature vector including: an identifier of the node; and for each communication channel of multiple predetermined communication channels, a representation of the communication channel based on:

the server node of each of the edges extending from the node as the client node on the communication channel; the client node of each of the edges extending to the node as the server node on the communication channel; and a collective representation of other communication channels not included in the predetermined communication channels; generating a node embedding comprising an output vector for each of the nodes of the graph by applying a graph neural network to the feature vectors of the nodes in the graph, wherein: the graph neural network is trained using a cost function modified by a weight setting function; the cost function includes a distance-based cost function and a network functionality cost function; the weight setting function is configured to modify a weight applied to the distance-based cost function and a weight applied to the network functionality cost function, such that: a higher weight is first applied to the distance-based cost function than the network functionality cost function; and a higher weight is later applied to the network functionality cost function than the distance-based cost function; the distance-based cost function is configured to: group together in space the output vectors for nodes that are connected by an edge; and push apart in space the output vectors for nodes not connected by an edge; and the network functionality cost function is configured to group together in space the output vectors for nodes based on a number of similar edges, such that: the output vectors for nodes having more similar edges are pulled together in space while the output vectors for nodes having fewer similar edges are pushed apart in space, wherein a similar edge is an edge having a same server node or a same client node; generating the network security policy comprising: identifying clusters in the output vectors of the generated node embedding; generating network security rules for each of the identified clusters, such that the network connections included in the network connection data involving the nodes included in the cluster are permitted by the network security rules for the nodes included in the cluster; and combining the network security rules to form the network security policy; and outputting the generated network security policy networking hardware including computer circuitry configured to: route the network connections included in the network traffic

between the two end points on the communication channel; log the network traffic as the network connection data; send the logged network connection data to the computer device; receive the generated network security policy; and apply the received network security policy to the network connections.

10. The system of claim 9 wherein each node in the graph represents at least one of an internet protocol (IP) address, a user identifier, or an application identifier.

11. The system of claim 9, wherein the communication channel for each network connection represents one or more of a port, application type, URL, or part of a URL.

12. The system of claim 9, wherein: the generating of the graph based on the received network connection data further comprises: applying weights to the generated edges, such that each of the generated edges has a weight based on a number of network connections in the network connection data from the server node to the client node on the communication channel represented by the edge; the representation of the communication channel is also based on: the weight of each of the edges extending from the node as the client node on the communication channel; and the weight of each of the edges extending to the node as the server node on the communication channel; and the collective representation of other communication channels not included in the predetermined communication channels is based on the weight of the edges extending from the node as the communication channel on any of the other communication channels.

13. The system of claim 9, wherein the weight setting function is configured to non-linearly vary the weight applied to the distance-based cost function and the weight applied to the network functionality cost function based on a distance between the output vectors.

14. The system of claim 9, wherein: the weight first applied to the distance-based cost function is one and the weight first applied to the network functionality cost function is zero; and the weight later applied to the distance-based cost function is zero and the weight later applied to the network functionality cost function is one.

15. The system of claim 9, wherein the network security policy for each of the identified clusters is generated, such that any network connections not included in the network connection data involving the nodes included in the cluster are blocked by the network security rules for the nodes included in the cluster.

16. A method for generating a network security policy automatically using processor circuitry based on network traffic comprising: receiving with the processor circuitry network connection data for network connections in the network traffic, wherein each network connection is on a communication channel between two end points; generating with the processor circuitry a graph based on the received network connection data comprising: identifying nodes in the graph, wherein each node in the graph comprises an end point of a network connection in the network connection data; generating edges between the identified nodes, wherein each edge of the generated edges: is directional and connects a client node and a server node; and represents communication on a communication channel from the client node to the server node; for each of the nodes in the graph, generating a feature vector including: an identifier of the node; and for each communication channel of multiple predetermined communication channels, a representation of the communication channel based on: the server node of each of the edges extending from the node as the client node on the communication channel; the client node of each of the edges extending to the node as the server node on the communication channel; and a collective representation of other communication channels not included in the predetermined communication channels; generating with the processor circuitry a node embedding comprising an output vector for each of the nodes of the graph by applying a graph neural network to the feature vectors of the nodes in the graph, wherein: the graph neural network is trained using a cost function modified by a weight setting function; the cost function includes a distance-based cost function and a network functionality cost function; the weight setting function is configured to modify a weight applied to the distance-based cost function and a weight applied to the network functionality cost function, such that: a higher weight is first

applied to the distance-based cost function than the network functionality cost function; and a higher weight is later applied to the network functionality cost function than the distance-based cost function; the distance-based cost function is configured to: group together in space the output vectors for nodes that are connected by an edge; and push apart in space the output vectors for nodes not connected by an edge; and the network functionality cost function is configured to group together in space the output vectors for nodes based on a number of similar edges, such that: the output vectors for nodes having more similar edges are pulled together in space while the output vectors for nodes having fewer similar edges are pushed apart in space, wherein a similar edge is an edge having a same server node or a same client node; generating with the processor circuitry the network security policy comprising: identifying clusters in the output vectors of the generated node embedding; generating network security rules for each of the identified clusters, such that the network connections included in the network connection data involving the nodes included in the cluster are permitted by the network security rules for the nodes included in the cluster; and combining the network security rules to form the network security policy; and outputting with the processor circuitry the generated network security policy.

17. The method of claim 16, further comprising applying the network security policy to network connections.

18. The method of claim 16, wherein: the generating of the graph based on the received network connection data further comprises: applying weights to the generated edges, such that each of the generated edges has a weight based on a number of network connections in the network connection data from the client node to the server node on the communication channel represented by the edge; the representation of the communication channel is also based on: the weight of each of the edges extending from the node as the client node on the communication channel; and the weight of each of the edges extending to the node as the server node on the communication channel; and the collective representation of other communication channels not included in the predetermined communication channels is based on the weight of the edges extending from the node as the communication channel on any of the other communication channels.

19. The method of claim 16, wherein the weight setting function is configured to non-linearly vary the weight applied to the distance-based cost function and the weight applied to the network functionality cost function based on a distance between the output vectors.

20. The method of claim 16, wherein: the weight first applied to the distance-based cost function is one and the weight first applied to the network functionality cost function is zero; and the weight later applied to the distance-based cost function is zero and the weight later applied to the network functionality cost function is one.
